

Answer to the Question No: 1

In the Jamaica Kincaid's "Girl" and "The Settler Cookbook" by Yasmin Alibhai-Brown and "My Boyhood Days" by Rabindranath Tagore, mothers have a significant role in the way the speakers perceive gender, family, and society. But the role of mothers in these works is not straightforward. They are affectionate, educative, nurturing, and occasionally restrictive. Above all, they assist the speakers in realizing that patriarchy is not merely a system dominated by the male, but one that also becomes embedded into the day-to-day life by the household rules, traditions, and expectations. These show that mothers often become the first medium through which children learn patriarchy. In "Girl," direct discipline is used and in "The Settler's Cookbook," cultural inheritance and gendered family roles are emphasized. In "My Boyhood Days," maternal care is highlighted within a society where women's lives were visibly restricted.

In "Girl," the mother's voice is the clearest example of how patriarchy is passed down inside the home. The story is made up mostly of the mother's uninterrupted instructions to her daughter. She teaches her how to wash clothes, cook, sew, smile, set the table, and behave around men. At first, these may seem like ordinary domestic lessons, but the deeper meaning is social and gendered. The daughter is repeatedly warned not to become "the slut" the mother believes she is "so bent on becoming." This bitter sentence shows that the mother has imprinted patriarchal ideals where the value of a girl lies in sexual decency and appropriate feminine behavior. The girl is shown that even walking, speaking, and eating have to be strictly regulated and not to be judged by others. What is especially important is that the daughter barely has a chance to respond. Her voice appears only briefly, and even then it is ignored or overwhelmed by the mother's lecture. This reflects the larger silencing of young women under patriarchy. However, the mother is not simply presented as cruel. Her constant warnings suggest fear as much as authority. She is aware that society is very judgmental to girls and thus she attempts to make her daughter fit in that world. By doing so, Kincaid demonstrates that mothers may turn into guardians and imposers of patriarchy. This is because the socio-cultural knowledge acquired by the daughter on womanhood is influenced by discipline, shame, and the need to be accepted by the society.

In “The Settler’s Cookbook” and “My Boyhood Days,” the role of the mother is less forceful in tone but still deeply influential. In Alibhai-Brown’s memoir, the mother is connected with food, memory, migration, and cultural belonging. The book is dedicated to her mother by the author who mentions that she provided her with an excellent source of creative recipes that bring our stories. This sentence is highly significant as it demonstrates that recipes are not all about cooking, they are a family history, a family identity, and sometimes emotional legacy. The speaker becomes informed about community, religion, loss, and belonging through her mother. However, this inheritance is also patriarchal, since food and childcare are attributed to the role of women in the family. The mother becomes the keeper of culture, yet this role itself comes from gendered expectations. In this sense, the speaker learns that women preserve family identity, but often from within limited and traditional roles. In “My Boyhood Days,” Tagore presents motherhood in a gentler and more indirect way. He remembers the moments of the motherly love, when his mother would permit him to skip his classes when he would complain that he was ill. In the meantime, his world is a clear sign of how women exist in a patriarchal society. He refers to the women who were transported in small palanquins and were not permitted to use the modern clothes or shoes. By these observations, Tagore realizes the life of women as being dominated by the concepts of modesty, propriety, and seclusion. His mother is not able to talk to him as Kincaid talks to his mother, but she has the same socio-cultural order. Tagore is a boy and thus does not go through these rules the same way. Rather, he picks up patriarchy through the way the women around him follow it. His mother is a humanizing element in the household, however, she remains within a system where the freedom of women is literally restricted in front of us.

In conclusion, these all three portray mothers as central figures in shaping the speakers’ understanding of patriarchy, though they do so differently. In *Girl*, the mother explicitly instills patriarchal rules in her daughter by correcting and threatening her all the time. The mother in *The Settler Cookbook* imparts culture and memory and identity through food, yet this inheritance is still determined by the gender expectations. The role of the mother in *My Boyhood Days* is less pronounced, but Tagore still gets to know about patriarchy by observing the way women live their lives in the family and the society. Collectively, these writings imply that patriarchy is not only exercised through the state or male domination. It is even taught close to, through mothers

who convey not only the weight, but also the techniques of survival of the worlds they have themselves inherited.

Answer to the Question No: 3

In the poem “The Emperor of Ice-Cream” by Wallace Stevens and “Chickpea to Cook” by Rumi, death is not presented as the only sad and scary or darkness. Rather, the two speakers refer to food metaphors to demonstrate that death is inevitable and significant. They do this however differently. “The Emperor of Ice-Cream” is a symbol of the temporary joys of material existence whereas “Chickpea to Cook” is a symbol of misery and transformation. Therefore the two poems glorify the inevitability of death via central metaphors of food but Stevens is highlighting death as the final truth of life when Rumi is highlighting the fact that it is the next phase of spiritual growth.

In the Emperor of Ice-Cream, the metaphor is actually the ice-cream. Ice-cream is connected with fun, joy and temporality of the life. Ice-cream melts fast, so it is a proper picture to show that human life and this worldly happiness are not permanent. The poem starts with a strange background that is when a dead woman is lying in a room yet the speaker tells people to make ice-cream. This death and celebration depicts that life continues even where death exists. The repetition of the line the only emperor is the emperor of ice-cream creates an impression that the short lived pleasure on earth is the master of human life. Ice-cream is referred to as emperor as it represents the here and now, the physical and the reality. Stevens makes this idea clearer in the line, “Let be be finale of seem.” Here, he means that death removes all illusion and reveals truth. The dead woman can no longer hide behind beauty or appearances. Her “horny feet” sticking out from the sheet show how cold and lifeless she has become. This is an unsubtle picture that makes death realistic instead of romantic. By using this metaphor, Stevens glorifies the inescapability of death by demonstrating that life is short, material, and should be taken with a truthful attitude.

The primary metaphor that has been employed in Chickpea to Cook is the metaphor of the chickpea being cooked in a pot and this metaphor turns the pain into a spiritual lesson. In contrast to the poem by Stevens, where death focuses on the material reality, in the poem by Rumi pain and destruction are viewed as a part of the process of divine. At the beginning of the poem, the chickpea tries to leap out of the pot and asks, “Why are you doing this to me?” This question expresses the natural human fear of suffering and death. The cook answers that boiling is not meaningless cruelty. Instead, it is necessary so that the chickpea can gain “flavor” and become “the lovely vitality of a human being.” This is the key metaphor of the poem: boiling represents the painful experiences of life, including suffering, ego-loss, and finally death, all of which prepare the soul for a higher state. The chickpea is first resistant, but later it submits and

even says, “Boil me some more.” This transformation is highly significant since it reflects acceptance. The chickpea starts by imagining that the cook is torturing it but too late it understands the cook is just leading it to fulfillment. The cook also tells, “I was once like you,” that transformation is everywhere. Death is not always the end in this poem; it is a passage to be more knowledgeable, innocent, closer to the Divine. The chickpea metaphor praises the unavoidability of death in that it shows it as a part of a meaningful spiritual path. What looks like a destruction itself, is preparation to a more complete form of existence.

Finally, the central food metaphors in both the poems “The Emperor of Ice-Cream” and “Chickpea to Cook” are the explanations of the inevitability of death and even its praise, but in very different ways. Ice-cream is employed by Stevens to underline the transient, physical, and sensual aspect of life that reminds readers of the fact that death reveals the truth and removes all illusion. Rumi uses the cooking chickpea to demonstrate that the tortures and death are components of the spiritual change, not just some meaningless sufferings. One of them is based on material truth, and the other on spiritual submission. However, both of them arrive at a similar conclusion that death is unavoidable and the understanding of this truth gives the meaning to life. In that aspect, neither of the speakers glorifies death by refusing to acknowledge that it is painful but by showing that it gives life its final meaning.